Team Rules for OpenAI Codex with AGENTS.md



Akmal Khan
Senior Full Stack AI Architect
akmalkhaniub.github.io

Author Audition

Overview



Maliha reviews the same mistakes, every PR

```
+ def apply_coupon(total, code):
+     if code != "SAVE10":
+         raise ValueError("Invalid coupon")
```

"Use AppError, not ValueError. And update CHANGELOG.md."
Maliha, for the fifth time this month

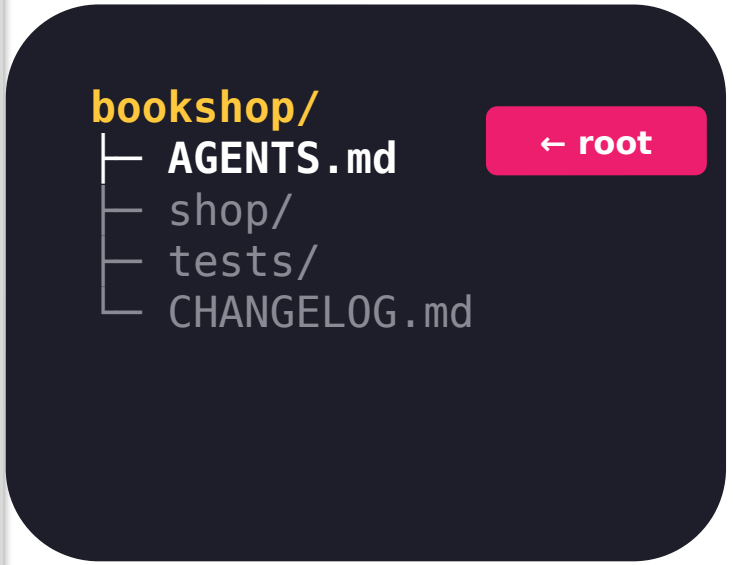
WHAT'S IN IT FOR YOU

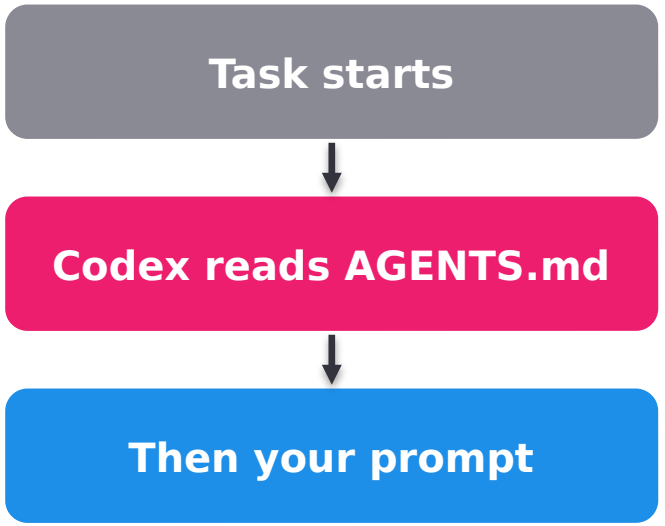
Codex pull requests that already follow your team's rules.

IN THIS AUDITION

1 Meet AGENTS.md → 2 Write checkable rules → 3 Prove it in a demo

1 Meet AGENTS.md





THINK OF IT AS

An onboarding note for a new teammate…

…who rereads it before every single task.

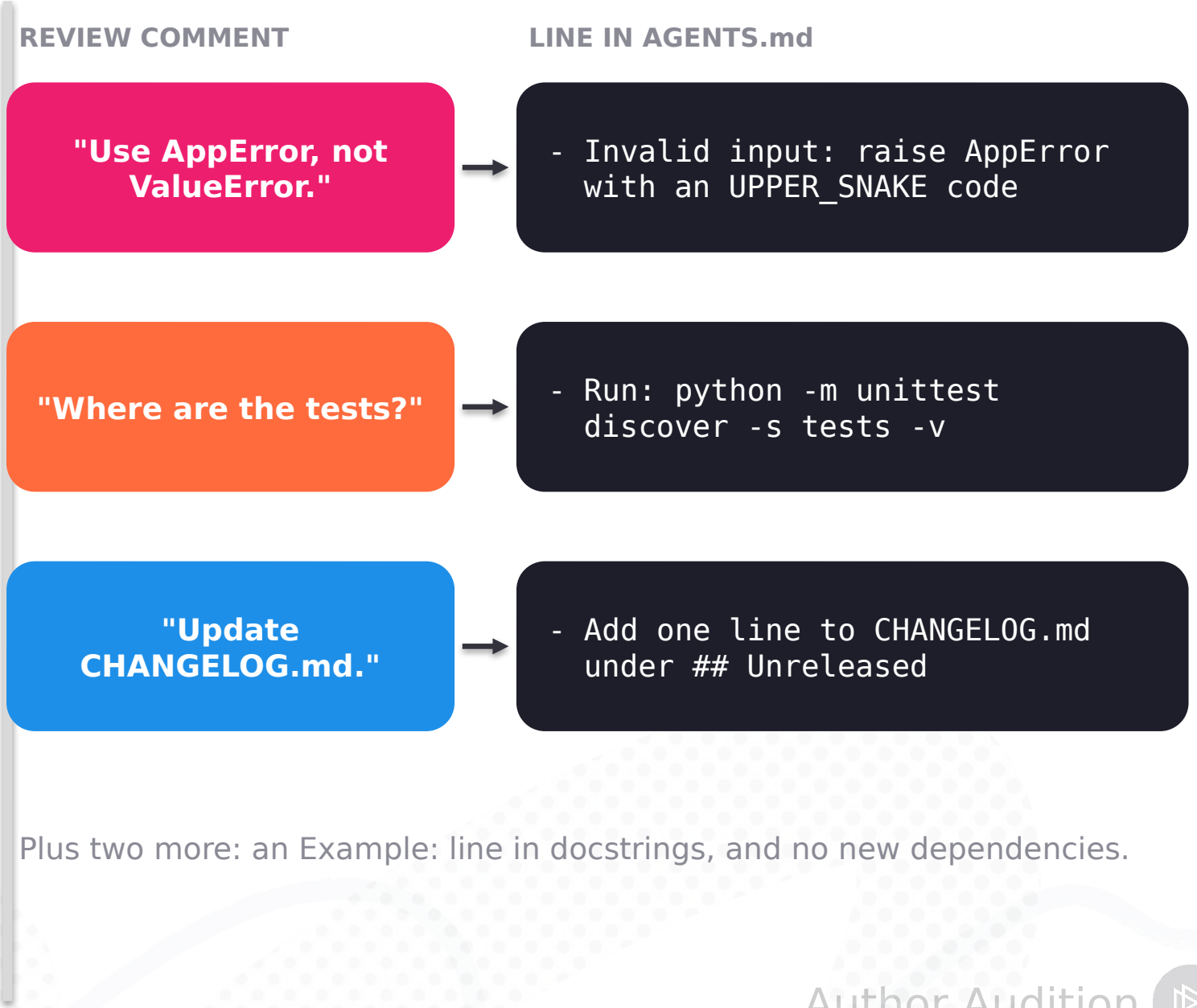
Changed the file? Start a new thread so Codex reads it again.

2 Write rules you can check

Weak rule	Checkable rule
"Handle errors properly"	**Raise AppError with an UPPER_SNAKE code**
"Test your changes"	**Run python -m unittest discover -s tests -v**
"Keep docs updated"	**One CHANGELOG.md line under Unreleased**

The test for every rule: could a reviewer check it in the diff?

2 From comments to rules



Plus two more: an Example: line in docstrings, and no new dependencies.

Demo



3 Prove it: same prompt, twice

1. **WITHOUT RULES**
   Ask Codex to add apply_coupon
2. **CHECK THE DIFF**
   Which of Maliha's comments still apply?
3. **ADD AGENTS.md**
   Copy the rules file to the repo root
4. **SAME PROMPT AGAIN**
   New thread, identical words
5. **COMPARE**
   The diff now follows every rule

Your first AGENTS.md

What do you correct in every code review?

Those are your first three rules.



Commit it, so every teammate and every thread gets it.

Summary



Write team rules once, in the repo

Make every rule checkable in a diff

Codex rereads them every task

Rules guide Codex. Review still checks